

Core i5 motherboards

The best of the Core i5 motherboards tested – there's something for everyone

Cellphones

In awareness, advertising seems to have helped Nokia, SE and LG, but not Samsung and Motorola

Cellphones

When asked, people wanted to buy other products mostly from Samsung; but other mobiles mostly from Nokia and SE

Icons of Trust

Cellphones / PDA Phones

Same old song and dance

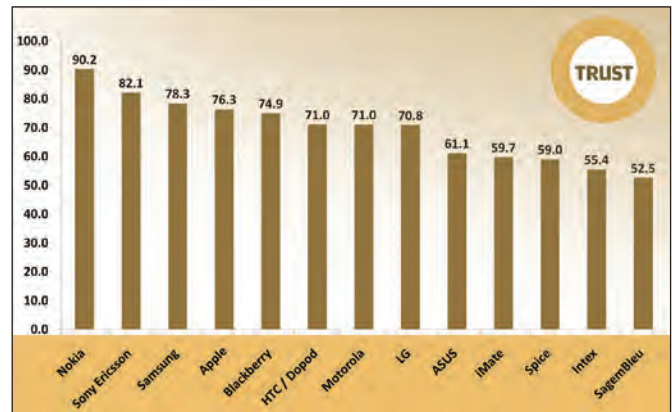
Obviously, being one of the most bought technology items, the mobile phone category is also one of the most hotly contested, with brands fighting tooth and nail for every decimal of a percentage of the market share.

Nokia did it again. All said and done, here's one brand that remains unchallenged in the mobile segment. Although Sony Ericsson comes in second, it would be a lie to say it was a close second. In all five of our parameters – awareness, credibility, loyalty, satisfaction and TCO (total cost of ownership) – Nokia stood alone at the top.

Sony Ericsson came in second in most parameters, and was no lower than third in any of the five. What this means is that for once, we have a clearer runner-up, which is not something the Nokia guys will ignore, no matter how far ahead they

are. The only times SE was displaced from its runner up slot were in the credibility and TCO parameters. It's very interesting to note that Apple seems to have more credibility than SE amongst our respondents – quite a feat considering Apple has basically just one phone model to its name! As for TCO, Samsung edged out SE by a smidge, giving us the impression that Samsung owners just spend less on repair and maintenance after purchase.

Samsung rose two ranks this year to come in third, just edging out Apple, who is our biggest climber – leap-frogging 3 ranks up from last year. BlackBerry fell two spots, and Motorola and LG have both slipped a notch from last year – thanks mainly to Apple's rise. We also saw two new entrants, Intex and HTC/Dopod. The latter shot straight into sixth place, which is commendable



I was looking for innovative applications and Apple does that really well. Also, I love the web browser on the iPhone.

Samrat Mazumdar, Bhubaneswar

In my house we have four handsets and they are all Nokia. We're all very used to Nokia. Also, once we bought a Motorola and it gave us a lot of trouble. If we dropped it, it had problems. With Nokia, you can drop it 3 or 4 times also and it will work fine.

Parimal Patel, Vadodara

for a brand that not many could identify with in last year's survey. Also, we have to mention ASUS, who climbed an impressive two spots this year, validating their increased efforts in this category.

A resounding victory for Nokia in the end, but we can't wait for next year, and hope that one of the others can give them a run for their money – stiff competition between brands is what brings joy to the consumer, after all.

Desktop PCs

Score one for branded

What's big here is that Dell has rallied from third place last year to take the crown away from HP/Compaq. It's a close fought battle, but Dell won four of the five battles in the race to be the *Icon of Trust*.

It's a two horse race when it comes to awareness, with unaided recall revealing that if you ask the average person to name PC brands, Dell and HP are pretty much the only answers you will get – again, advertising bucks well spent.

Credibility sees Apple jump from nowhere into third behind the big two. Apple is the third most trusted in terms of build quality, and comes in second for innovativeness. Dell and Apple (in that order) also rule the roost when it comes to what the respondents thought was a stylish brand.

For satisfaction, most people stuck to Dell and HP/Compaq as their top two. Interestingly, Apple, again, got very high scores for quality of their products – coming in second behind Dell. As expected, when it came to how easily available products were across geographies, HP/Compaq obliterated its opponents, with only Assembled PCs being able to tussle for top spot.

When it comes to loyalty, it's more of the same. The only interesting change here are that when asked whether the respondents were confident buying another product from the same brand, in a different product category, Sony got a big thumbs up, coming in second.

TCO questions led us to believe that the assembler market is still the cheapest way to get service and repairs. HCL jumped into the fray here, coming in at



Dell machines are priced just right. They have excellent after-sales service.

Amit Ranjan, Guwahati

I've been using Lenovo and I've had no problems. My friends own Compaq and HP and always complain about the DVD drive.

Ratul Nandi, Gurgaon

third for TCO. Dell fell to fourth place in this parameter.

In the overall trust index, it was Dell all the way, with HP/Compaq a close second. The major improvement here is by

Lenovo and Apple, climbing three and two places since last year. On the flip side, Acer fell a massive three spots, which is sad for one of the world's largest PC manufacturers.